



Rivers and lakes



Did you know?

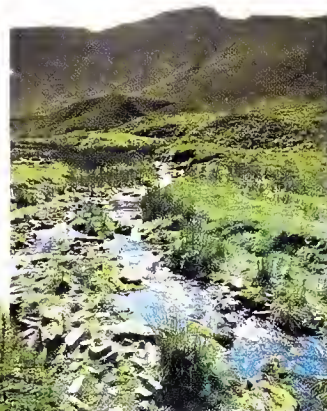
Some rivers contain water only once or twice a year when there is rain.



Rivers are always on the move. They carry rainwater downhill, from mountains to the ocean.

1 River source

Rainwater trickles into the ground. It comes out at one place – a river's source.

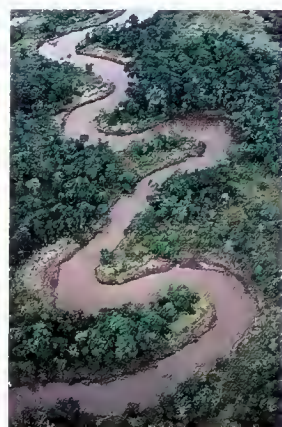


2 Stream

From the source, a small stream flows downhill. The water is clean and fast flowing.

A river's course

Rivers start life as trickles, but as they flow into each other, they become larger and slower.



Shallow stream

Fast-flowing water

Big rocks

Clear, clean water

3 River

A stream becomes a river as more water flows in. It forms big bends called meanders.



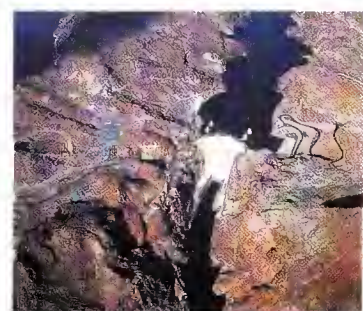
4 River mouth

The river flows into the ocean. This is called the river mouth.

Uses of rivers and lakes



Water sports, such as fishing and sailing, are popular activities.



Hydroelectric power stations make electricity from the power of a river.



Water transportation is an important way of moving goods from place to place.



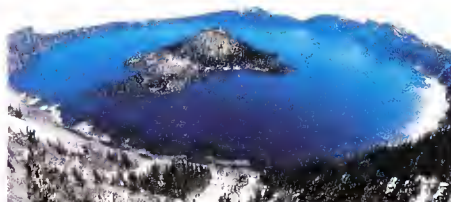
Irrigation pumps water from lakes and rivers to dry fields to help crops grow.

Lakes

Lakes are dips in the ground that are filled by rain- and river water. Some lakes are man-made.



Reservoirs are built by people.



Crater lakes form naturally when rainwater collects inside a volcano.

